

ANIMA Holding S.p.A. ANIM

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by

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			2026	2027
Price:	7.16	EPS	0.94	0.96
Shares Out. (in M):	328	P/E	7.6	7.5
Market Cap (in \$M):	2,348	P/FCF	8.2	8.1
Net Debt (in \$M):	-604	EBIT	336	342
TEV (in \$M):	1,744	TEV/EBIT	5.2	5.1

Description

ANIMA Holding S.p.A. ("**ANIMA**") is an Italian asset manager with EUR 200bn AUM, listed on the Euronext Milan exchange, with a EUR 3.2bn market cap and EUR 1.7bn TEV. ANIMA is an 89.9% subsidiary of Banco BPM ("**BPM**"), and has successfully grown through acquisitions of smaller asset managers, and through leveraging the distribution network of its existing and former shareholders.

At 8.6x LTM P/E, ANIMA trades at an attractive price with solid growth and a 7% dividend yield. The dividend has grown at a 10-year CAGR of 11.5%. ANIMA also holds significant net cash + securities as of June 2026 of EUR 604m, reflecting 26% of its market cap. This balance belongs to ANIMA and is not attributable to third-party client accounts. ANIMA's cash + securities balance is rapidly growing, in part because it includes a 4.0% shareholding in Banca MPS, which has doubled its share price in the past 12 months.

I believe that ANIMA's shares are undervalued as a result of its limited float and investor fatigue in the asset management sector. The investment case has multiple paths to value realization. Most likely, BPM will launch another tender offer. Assuming an unheroic exit multiple of 11x FY26e adj. EPS, equivalent to 7.0x FY26e EBITDA, an investment in ANIMA could generate a 1.4x MoIC over the next 12 months. Shareholders are paid to wait by receiving a high dividend and participating in ANIMA's growth.

ANIMA pays an annual dividend in April to May of each year. BPM's 2024 tender offer announcement was timed 7 months prior to its dividend payment date - implying the possibility of a near-term catalyst in 4Q26.

Company Background

ANIMA Holding S.p.A. is a EUR 200bn AUM Italian asset manager with more than one million clients, including retail, private HNW, insurers, and pensions. Its operating subsidiaries include:

- ANIMA for retail and institutional asset management (EUR 195bn AUM),
- Kairos Partners for HNWI, acquired in 2024 from Julius Baer (EUR 11bn AUM).
- ANIMA Alternatives / Castello for alternatives and private real estate, acquired in 2023 (80%) and 2026 (20%), from Oaktree (EUR 6.5bn AUM).

ANIMA has developed a sticky distribution network that is difficult to replicate, leveraging BPM's network of around 1,300 branches. It also utilizes the networks of two former shareholders, Banca Monte dei Paschi di Siena S.p.A. ("**MPS**"), which operates around 1,300 branches, and the Italian Post Office, Poste Italiane S.p.A. ("**PST**"), which operates around 12,700 postal branches through which insurance and financial products are sold to retail clients.

ANIMA's client mix is composed of 46% institutions (primarily PST insurance), 32% retail (of which 49% are BPM clients and 28% are MPS clients), and 13% B2B2C (primarily PST distributed retail funds, sub-advised by ANIMA). ANIMA operates with long-term contracts with PST expiring in 2033 and MPS expiring in 2030. These long-term contracts underscore the relative durability of ANIMA's institutional customer base versus typical sub-advisory relationships in the sector.

Over the past five and ten years, ANIMA has grown EBITDA at a consistent CAGR of approx. 10% - not a bad outcome for an industry facing secular competitive headwinds.

Evolution of ANIMA's Ownership

The following summarizes ANIMA's historical ownership, which is relevant with regard to understanding ANIMA's distribution network and catalysts for the stock.

- **2007:** BPM acquired a 29.9% interest in ANIMA, primarily through acquiring a block from Banco di Desio e della Brianza, which was ANIMA's largest shareholder dating back to 1999.
- **2008-09:** BPM launched a successful tender offer for the 70.1% stake in Sep-08, with a 17% premium to the three-month VWAP. ANIMA was delisted in Mar-09.

- **2010-11:** ANIMA merged with BPM's asset-management subsidiary, Bipiemme Gestioni, and a third-party asset manager, Prima SGR. As a result, ANIMA's shareholding was restructured to BPM (36%), MPS (23%), and Italian PE sponsor Clessidra (38%).
- **2014-15:** ANIMA Holding was re-listed on the Milan stock exchange, BPM's shareholding was reduced to 14.7%, and Clessidra exited its stake in the public market.
- **2015:** PST acquired a 10% stake in ANIMA from MPS, and used ANIMA as a sub-advisor for funds and insurance products, which it distributes through the Italian post office system.
- **2017:** ANIMA acquired Aletti Gestielle from BPM in Aug '17. Aletti Gestielle was an asset manager acquired by BPM through its merger with Banco Popolare in Jan '17.
- **2020:** BPM increased its shareholding in ANIMA to 22% through open-market purchases, once again becoming ANIMA's largest shareholder.

BPM's Tender Offer

In Nov-24, BPM announced a voluntary public tender offer at EUR 6.2/sh cum-dividend, reflecting a 17% premium to ANIMA's 3-month VWAP. In Feb-25, BPM increased its offer price by an additional 13% to EUR 7.0/sh. As of the Apr-25 completion date, BPM achieved 68% acceptances, increasing its shareholding to 89.9%.

The fairness opinion referenced multiples of Amundi, DWS, Schroder, Man Group, and Aberdeen Group, which at that time averaged 10.7x P/E and 6.8x EV/EBITDA. BPM's EUR 7.0/sh offer for ANIMA reflected a 10.5x P/E (on adjusted EPS) and 6.7x EV/EBITDA. An independent DCF valued ANIMA at EUR 6.7-8.2/sh at that time.

Since then, this peer group has re-rated higher, towards a low to mid-teens P/E and 9.0 - 10.0x EV/EBITDA multiple range.

Following the Apr-25 closing of its tender offer, BPM stated that it is considering alternatives for ANIMA's remaining listed minority interest. These alternatives include another tender offer, bringing in new partners to expand ANIMA's distribution capabilities (which could also imply another tender offer), or maintaining ANIMA's listing.

The ownership threshold for a compulsory squeeze-out is 95%. BPM could also implement a delisting at a 90% threshold, in which case it must also provide a buy-out offer to minorities, with Italy's independent securities market regulator, Commissione Nazionale per le Società e la Borsa ("**CONSOB**") setting the valuation.

Financial Overview

FYE - Dec.	Forecast					
	2023	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E	2028E
AUM (€bn)						
AUMs (€bn)	191.5	203.1	210.9	210.9	220.8	231.3
AUM excl. class I	109.8	124.0	133.3	134.5	144.1	154.2
Insurance Class I AUM	81.7	79.1	77.6	76.4	76.7	77.0
Net mgmt fee margin (bps)	15.7	17.1	18.1	18.1	18.1	18.1
Income statement (€m)						
Net management fees	290	339	364	372	381	401
Performance fees	35	125	82	102	109	129
Other fees	43	66	70	71	71	71
Revenue	368	530	516	545	561	600
Staff costs	-65	-127	-99	-109	-118	-126
Other opex	-42	-54	-57	-56	-57	-58
Total expenses	-108	-181	-156	-165	-175	-184
EBITDA	260	349	360	380	386	416
D&A	-44	-46	-45	-44	-44	-44
EBIT	216	303	315	336	342	373
Net finance income	5	12	43	44	45	47
Other	-1	6	24	2	2	2
EBT	221	322	382	382	389	422
Income tax expense	-71	-94	-115	-103	-105	-115
NPAT (Reported)	150	228	267	279	284	307
Adj. NPAT	181	248	306	310	315	338
EPS	0.45	0.70	0.82	0.86	0.87	0.94
Adj. EPS	0.54	0.76	0.93	0.94	0.96	1.03
DPS	0.25	0.45	0.50	0.55	0.60	0.65
Avg shares O/S	334	327	328	328	328	328
Net Cash + Securities	5	277	491	684	799	936

- In recent years, net fee margins have expanded as a result of higher relative contribution of retail AUM. If this trend continues, EPS could outperform versus expectations.
- Expected takeout valuation of EUR 10.0/sh is based on 11x FY26 EPS, on a cum-dividend basis. This is roughly equivalent to a 7.0x FY26 EV/EBITDA multiple. Alternatively, a takeout valuation using an EV/EBITDA multiple closer to ANIMA's peer group of 9x would result in EUR 12.5/sh valuation, implying a potential 1.75x MoIC.

Risks

- Possibility of a take-under and coercion given the lack of competing bidders, with a tender offer potentially structured with a dividend cancellation and proposal to delist
- Competition and secular fee pressure from passive investment products

I do not hold a position with the issuer such as employment, directorship, or consultancy.

I and/or others I advise do not hold a material investment in the issuer's securities.

Catalyst

- Tender offer
- Organic growth
- Growing dividend

Messages

Subject**Entry****Member**

Correction to first sentence EUR 2.3bn market cap.

Minor correction

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